

ENG509 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 06 to 10

ENG509 Morphology and Syntax

EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM

REGARDS : SIR ZAHID: 03342743020

Join Our WhatsApp Group 🖱️ VU-All-(Bs English Group)

Click 🖱️ [\(JOIN NOW\)](#)

Lesson 06

Words & Its Relatives: Derivation: I

Topic 31: Relationships between lexemes - Derivation: I

What determines the appearance of -s, -ed, or -ing in words like "perform"?

Grammatical factors determine the choice of these suffixes in appropriate contexts.

Why is "performance" not formed with -ance as a grammatical requirement?

There's no grammatical factor requiring the presence of -ance on "performance."

Is the suffix -ance considered inflectional?

No, it's derivational because it's not inflectional.

How do you define derivational morphology?

Derivational morphology includes all aspects of word structure involving affixation that are not inflectional.

What's the relationship between "perform" and "performance"?

It's a relationship between lexemes, not word forms.

What are the factors that determine the appearance of -s, -ed, or -ing in words like "perform"?

Grammatical factors, specific to appropriate contexts, determine the choice between "perform," "performs," and "performed."

Topic 32: Word classes and conversion

How is the word class to which a lexeme belongs determined?

Mainly by its meaning, but this can be incorrect in some cases.

What's an example of a word class determined by meaning that doesn't work well?

"Perform" and "performance" seem related by meaning but belong to different word classes.

Can a lexeme have both noun and verb forms?

Yes, some roots have both noun and verb forms.

What are examples of ambivalent words?

"Wish," "desire," "father," "hope," and "fear."

How can verbs change classes without overt changes in form?

They can be "converted" from one class to another without changing their shape.

How can verbs change classes without overt changes in form, and why might relying on meaning as a criterion be problematic?

Verbs can change classes through a process known as conversion, where their basic form remains unchanged, but they may take on a different grammatical function. Relying solely on meaning for classification can be problematic because,

in some cases, it doesn't account for the syntactic and inflectional evidence that justifies the classification.

Topic 33: Adverbs derived from adjectives

Do all adverbs end in -ly?

No, simple adverbs like "often" and "never" don't end in -ly.

What are some common adverbs formed by conversion?

"Fast" (as in "driven fast") and "hard" (as in "worked hard") are examples.

Topic 34: Nouns derived from nouns

What are some derivational processes for creating nouns from nouns?

Examples include "-let," "-ess," "-er," "-ship," "-hood," and "-ist."

Why don't all nouns in -ity follow a predictable pattern?

Some nouns in -ity are exceptions because they don't correspond directly to the adjectival forms.

What are some suffixes used to derive nouns from adjectives?

"-ity," "-ness," and "-ism" are examples.

Topic 35: Adjectives derived from adjectives

What does the suffix -ish indicate when added to adjectives?

It means "somewhat X," such as in "greenish."

What are some prefixes used to create negative adjectives?

"Un-," "il-," "ir-," and "im-" are used to create negative adjectives.

Topic 36: Verbs derived from verbs

What are some common prefixes for verbs that denote reversal or negation?

"Re-," "un-," "de-," and "dis-" are used for this purpose.

What's an example of causative verb-pairs formed through conversion?

"Boil" and "unboil," where "un-" negates the action.

How are verbs derived from adjectives and nouns?

Some examples include "de-," "-ise," and "-ify" for adjectives and "de-," "-en," and "-ate" for nouns.

Can you explain the relationship between intransitive and transitive verbs, providing examples?

Intransitive verbs don't take an object, while transitive verbs involve an object. For example, "lie" (intransitive) contrasts with "lay" (transitive).

Lesson 07

Words & Its Relatives: Derivation: II

Topic 37: Compounds versus Phrases

What are compounds and how are they formed in English?

Compounds are words formed by combining roots.

What are phrasal words, and how do they differ from compounds?

Phrasal words have the internal structure of phrases but function syntactically as words.

What is the distinction between compounds and phrases based on?

The distinction is based on both stress patterns and semantic idiosyncrasy.

How are phrases like "green house" and "greenhouse" differentiated in terms of stress?

"Green house" is stressed on the last word, while "greenhouse" is stressed on the first part.

Topic 38: Compound Verbs

What are the four types of compound verbs discussed in the lesson?

- (1) verb–verb (VV)
- (2) noun–verb (NV)
- (3) adjective–verb (AV)
- (4) preposition–verb (PV)

Which type of compound verb is the most common?

Preposition–verb (PV) compounds are the most common.

Can you provide examples of compounds with "out-" as a prefix?

"Out-" can create transitive verbs from any verb denoting a competitive or potentially competitive activity.

What is the term used to describe compounds where the rightmost element is the head?

These compounds are called "right-headed."

Could you provide examples of compounds using the prefix "out-" (Topic 38)?

"Out-" can create transitive verbs that mean "outdo in Xing" from verbs denoting competitive activities, such as "outsail," "outsing," and "outswim."

Topic 39: Compound Nouns and Headed and Headless Compounds

In which part of speech does compounding predominantly occur in English?

Compounding predominantly occurs with nouns.

What is a primary or root compound, and can you provide an example?

A primary or root compound is a compound where the right-hand noun is not derived from a verb, and its interpretation is not precisely predictable on a purely linguistic basis. Example: "hair restorer."

What distinguishes a headed compound from a headless one?

Headed compounds have an internal "center," whereas headless compounds lack this internal "center."

Topic 40: Blends and Acronyms

What are blends in compound words?

Blends are compound words where at least one component is partially reproduced from the original words.

Can you give examples of acronyms?

Examples of acronyms include NATO, SCSI, and AIDS.

What is the difference between an acronym and an abbreviation?

Acronyms are pronounced as words, while abbreviations are pronounced by naming each letter individually.

Topic 41: Compounds containing Bound Combining Forms

What are combining forms, and how do they differ from free roots?

Combining forms are bound roots used to create compounds. They are typically borrowed from Greek or Latin and used in technical vocabulary.

How do combining forms like "anthrop(o)-" and "-logy" contribute to the meaning of compound words?

Combining forms help determine the meaning of the whole compound. For example, "anthrop(o)-" means "human," and "-logy" means "science or study."

Topic 42: Phrasal Words

How do phrasal words differ from compound words?

Phrasal words have an internal structure similar to phrases or clauses but behave as single words.

Give an example of a phrasal word.

"Jack-in-the-box" is an example of a phrasal word.

Are phrasal words always nouns, or can they also be adjectives?

Phrasal words can be adjectives as well, as seen in examples like "dyed-in-the-wool" and "couldn't-care-less."

What distinguishes phrasal words from compound words (Topic 42)?

Phrasal words have an internal structure that resembles phrases or clauses but function as individual words in syntax, whereas compound words typically have a different word order.

Lesson 08

Morphological Structures

Topic 43: Morphological Structures - Introduction

How is the meaning of a word derived?

The meaning of a word is not just the sum of individual morpheme meanings; it's derived from their compositional structure.

What is the importance of word structure in semantics?

Word structure, or morphology, is crucial for understanding how individual units combine to provide a word's meaning.

Why is "undecidable" interpreted as "cannot be decided" and not "can be not decided"?

"Undecidable" refers to something that, under any circumstances, cannot be decided, making it a structural interpretation.

How does the position of the "un-" morpheme influence the word's meaning?

The position of the "un-" morpheme determines whether it modifies a suffix or relates to the verb, affecting the word's meaning.

Topic 44: Morphological Properties

What defines the head of a morphological structure?

The head is the unit that imparts its properties to the entire word, including grammatical and semantic properties.

Why can't a bound morpheme typically stand alone?

Bound morphemes, like "ment" in "government," can't stand alone because they require attachment to other morphemes to form complete words.

How does morphology differ from syntax?

Morphology doesn't follow the same rules as syntax; for instance, a head in morphology is frequently a bound morpheme, while in syntax, heads can stand alone.

Topic 45: A-Morphous Morphology

What does A-morphous morphology propose about word structure?

A-morphous morphology suggests that words may not have an internal structure and that segmented units may not exist.

How does A-morphous morphology challenge traditional morphological analysis?

A-morphous morphology challenges the idea of segmenting words into smaller units with clear meanings.

What are some examples of phonaesthemes?

Phonaesthemes are sequences of sounds that evoke specific meanings, such as the "sl" sound in words like "slide," "slip," and "slink."

Topic 46: Exocentricity

What is exocentricity in morphology?

Exocentricity is a situation in which none of the units within a word explains its properties, challenging the concept of internal word structure.

How does exocentricity relate to compounding?

Exocentricity is often observed in compounding when the units within the word don't explain the word's semantics.

Topic 47: Bracketing Paradoxes

What are bracketing paradoxes in morphological structure?

Bracketing paradoxes occur when the formal and semantic properties of a word don't coincide, creating challenges for word structure analysis.

Give an example of a bracketing paradox.

"International" presents a bracketing paradox where the formal properties suggest one structure, but the meaning implies another.

How does the word "vulgar Latinist" illustrate a bracketing paradox?

"Vulgar Latinist" shows a bracketing paradox because it requires the suffix to combine with a larger structure, not just a single word.

Topic 48: Parasyntesis

What is parasyntesis in morphology?

Parasyntesis is when two different affixes, typically a prefix and a suffix, seem to be added simultaneously to the same base.

How does parasyntesis challenge the concept of binary branching in word structure?

Parasyntesis raises doubts about binary branching, as it involves adding more than two units to a base simultaneously.

What is a potential solution to the issue of parasyntesis?

One solution is to consider the prefix and suffix as a discontinuous morpheme, forming a circumfix, although it has some empirical challenges.

Lesson 09

Derivation and Semantics

Topic 49: Introduction: Derivation & Semantics

Why is the Bucharest sign funny?

Because "unbearable" implies an inherent quality that doesn't change when an elevator is broken.

What complex interaction is discussed in this chapter?

The interaction between affixation and semantics.

Topic 50: Polysemy Problem

What is the most fundamental aspect of a word's meaning?

Referring to some entity or relation in the world (semantic type).

What is polysemy?

The problem of words having multiple related meanings.

Give an example of a polysemous word.

"Lose" (e.g., lost passports, lost his job, lost her husband, lost my temper, lost ten pounds).

Topic 51: The Semantics of Derived Lexemes

What factors can affect a word's meaning?

Context, history, and individual usage.

How do children modify their word meanings during language acquisition?

They may under-extend or over-extend words but revise their lexical entries as they encounter more examples.

What is meant by "the meaning of a word is a compilation of every single use"?

The meaning of a word is influenced by personal history, historical usage, and individual experiences.

Why can the meanings of words become complex and diverse over time?

Due to the cumulative impact of various usages and historical contexts.

What question does the chapter address about lexeme-formation rules?

Whether derived forms have complicated or simple meanings similar to lexemes or syntactic collocations.

Topic 52: The Semantics of Affixation

Give an example of a suffix with highly lexicalized meanings.

"-ism," which can mean "doctrinal system of principles" or "a peculiarity of speech."

What does the German suffix "-ei" mean when attached to a noun? To a verb?

Attached to a noun, it means "the place in which X works." Attached to a verb stem, it means "the act of doing X."

In English, what is a cognate suffix of French origin with examples?

"(e)ry," as in "bakery," "tannery," "winery," "bribery," "flattery," and "foolery."

Topic 53: The Semantics of Zero-Derivation

What is zero-derivation?

A word formation process that results in lexemes with context-dependent interpretations.

Why do zero-derived verbs often have a wide range of meanings?

They are created based on conversational convention rather than a specific rule.

What is the common factor among various meanings of zero-derived verbs?

They all involve an activity connected with the noun.

Topic 54: English Agent Nouns in -er

What are the four basic categories of English agent nouns in -er?

Persons, animals, material objects, and immaterial objects.

What can agent nouns be divided into based on usage?

Habitual and non-habitual uses.

What are two possible methods for analyzing agent nouns?

Sparse semantic rule (connected with what the base denotes) and prototypes (a central case with variations).

What is the prototypical agentive for agent nouns?

A person who habitually performs a particular type of action.

Lesson 10

Inflections

Topic 55: Introduction to Inflection

What is the plural of "euro" in English?

The plural of "euro" is "euros."

What is the productive plural marker in English, and when is it used?

The productive plural marker in English is "-s," and it is used with new coinages, such as "modem" or "byte" (e.g., modems, bytes).

In Ireland, is it "four euro" or "four euros"? Why?

In Ireland, it is "four euro" and not "four euros" because of the multilingual nature of the euro zone.

Why is the plural form of "euro" uniform on a 10-euro bill?

The plural form of "euro" is uniform on a 10-euro bill to accommodate the multilingual nature of the euro zone and ensure consistent representation in all languages.

What is the second problem related to the plural form of "euro" on a 10-euro bill?

The second problem on a 10-euro bill is related to the uniform representation of the plural form of "euro." Although several major European languages use the plural marker "-s," some, like Italian, do not. Thus, the bill reads "10 EURO/EYPW,"

and most spoken languages follow the practice of not using a plural marker, making the plural of "euro" "euro" in Ireland.

What linguistic point does the story of "euro" illustrate about languages sharing the same word?

The linguistic point is that even when multiple languages share the same word, such as "euro," their inflectional systems differ, and this difference can affect the forms of words. Inflection varies more between languages than other systematic aspects of language.

Topic 56: What is Inflection?

What is inflection in linguistics?

Inflection in linguistics involves altering the shape of a word to fit a particular syntactic context, often to express morphosyntactic features such as tense, aspect, number, and case.

What kinds of information do lexemes express through inflection?

Lexemes express morphosyntactic information through inflection, including categories like tense, aspect, number, and case.

What is exponence in linguistic morphology?

Exponence refers to the realization of morphosyntactic features via inflection.

What is context-free inflection, and can you provide an example?

Context-free inflection is when there is a simple, direct mapping between a morphosyntactic feature and a particular phonological string. Example: All present participles in English bear the same suffix, "-ing."

What is the difference between context-free and context-sensitive inflection?

Context-free inflection occurs when there's a simple mapping between a morphosyntactic feature and a specific phonological string. An example is the suffix "-ing" in English, which applies to all present participles. In contrast, context-sensitive inflection means that the feature's realization varies depending on the lexeme it attaches to, like the past tense in English, which is context-sensitive.

Topic 57: Inflection vs. Derivation

What is the main difference between inflection and derivation?

The main difference is that inflection does not change the core lexical meaning or category of a word, while derivation can change the meaning and sometimes the category.

What is meant by "suppletion" in inflectional morphology?

Suppletion occurs when the syntax requires a form of a lexeme that is not morphologically predictable, leading to distinct phonological shapes for related forms.

Topic 58: Inventory of Inflectional Morphology Types

What are some common ways to express inflectional categories in languages?

Common ways include affixation, stem alternations, apophony (vowel changes), reduplication, and suppletion.

In which language does affixation often interact with stem alternations in expressing inflection?

Latin is a language where affixation often interacts with stem alternations in the expression of inflectional categories.

What is "fusion" in the context of inflection, and what language exemplifies fusion?

Fusion refers to a situation where a single form represents multiple morphosyntactic features. Latin, which exhibits noun declensions, exemplifies fusion, with morphemes like "-ōs" covering multiple features.

Topic 60: Syncretism

What is syncretism in linguistics?

Syncretism occurs when a single inflected form corresponds to more than one set of morphosyntactic features.

Give an example of syncretism in the Bulgarian language.

In Bulgarian, the second person singular and third person singular forms are often identical, leading to syncretism in verb conjugation.

Topic 60: Syncretism (Continued)

What is the fundamental typological distinction regarding language structures, and what is at the analytical end of this scale?

The fundamental typological distinction is from analytic to synthetic languages. Isolating languages, like Vietnamese, are at the analytical end.

What is the difference between agglutinating and fusional languages regarding morphology?

In agglutinating languages like Turkish or Hungarian, affixes are separated and express single notions distinctly, while in fusional languages like Latin, affixes fuse multiple morphosyntactic features.

What are some examples of polysynthetic languages, and what makes them unique?

Polysynthetic languages, such as Nuuchahnulth, can express complex notions in a single word, including subject, verb, object, and other information, making them unique in their ability to convey complex ideas within one word.

Sir Zahid

Working on the Next Lessons

Don't Copy Paste on any other platform

LMS Handling Service : 03342743020

Remember me in your prayers